
Addiction to Your Own Phone

The creator swallowed by what they create

4 psychology approaches · by EvaTalk

TO BEGIN

The creator swallowed by what they create

Creating content means living in your phone — and ending up swallowed by it: checking stats, notifications, endless scrolling. The creator is doubly hooked: consuming AND monitoring their own numbers.

This guide helps you reclaim control of your attention, without guilt.

YOUR INTENTION

What pulls you in most on your phone (stats, notifications, scroll): _____

The dopamine loop

Notifications, likes, stats trigger small, unpredictable dopamine hits, making them very addictive. As a creator, you're hooked twice: by the scroll, and by compulsively checking your own numbers.

Understanding the loop means no longer believing it's a lack of willpower.

Example

Sami checked his stats every 5 minutes; understanding the dopamine loop helped him defuse it.

My loop

Which compulsive gesture do you keep doing without thinking?

Not willpower

Write: 'It's a loop designed to hook, not a lack of willpower.'

Takeaway — Notifications and stats trigger a dopamine loop — not a willpower flaw.

'I must be there 24/7'

'I must be connected constantly', 'if I unplug, I miss everything', 'replying instantly is mandatory': these thoughts keep you glued to the screen.

Reframing them lets you disconnect without anxiety.

Example

'If I don't reply right away, I lose people' panicked Léa, until she saw nothing collapsed when she unplugged.

Spot the pressure

Note a thought gluing you to the screen · a fairer version.

The right to unplug

Write: 'I can disconnect without missing everything.'

Takeaway — You don't have to be available 24/7: disconnecting breaks nothing.

Your life off-screen matters

Your real life — your relationships, your body, your present moments — deserves more than crumbs of attention. Disconnecting regularly isn't neglecting your job: it's preserving what truly nourishes you. Reclaiming your attention is reclaiming your life.

Example

By imposing phone-free times, Nia found a presence and energy the scroll was stealing.

My real life

What does your phone steal from you, in your life off-screen?

Present

Write: 'My life off-screen deserves more than crumbs.'

Takeaway — Your life off-screen deserves more than crumbs of attention.

Digital hygiene

In practice: turn off non-essential notifications, set time slots to check your stats (instead of continuously), establish phone-free moments (meals, waking, bedtime), and physically distance the device when you want to be present. Attention is protected by your environment, not by willpower alone.

Make scrolling a bit harder to access: your brain will thank you.

Example

By turning off notifications and putting his phone away at night, Karim regained hours and calm.

My rule

A digital-hygiene rule to set this week: _____

Protect my attention

Write: 'I protect my attention through my environment.'

Takeaway — Notifications off, check slots, phone-free moments: protect your attention.

Key takeaways

- Notifications and stats trigger a dopamine loop — not a willpower flaw.
- You don't have to be available 24/7: disconnecting breaks nothing.
- Your life off-screen deserves more than crumbs of attention.
- Turn off non-essential notifications.
- Set time slots to check your stats (instead of continuously).
- Establish phone-free moments and distance the device.

Your turn

My loop

My compulsive gesture	The thought gluing me to the screen

My hygiene

What my phone steals	My digital-hygiene rule

YOUR JOURNEY

Your 4-week plan

Week 1

Understand the dopamine loop.

Week 2

Reframe 'I must be there 24/7'.

Week 3

Reconnect with my life off-screen.

Week 4

Set my digital-hygiene rules.

YOUR PLAN

Your action plan

My 'my life off-screen deserves more' line:

What my phone steals from me:

My digital-hygiene rule:

Reclaim your attention: you create with your phone, you don't belong to it.

This guide is a coaching and psychoeducation tool, not therapy. A creator's life can be draining: if you feel overwhelmed, a professional (psychologist) can help. © PerfectMatch · EvaTalk.